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Misa Kurihara

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WORK

July 2026-

Visiting Faculty Member

Graduate school of Informatics, Nagoya University, Aichi, Japan

April 2026-

Postdoctoral Research Fellow of the Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS)

Senshu University, Graduate School of Humanities, Kanagawa, Japan

June 2025 - December 2025

Visiting researcher

Brighton and Sussex Medical School, University of Sussex, Brighton, United Kingdom (Host: Prof. Hugo Critchley)

March 2025 – May 2025

Research student

Department of Applied Social Sciences, Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong (Host: Prof. Yin Wu)

April 2025 – March 2026

Researcher

Department of Cognitive and Psychological Sciences, Graduate school of Informatics, Nagoya University, Aichi, Japan

April 2023 - March 2024

Visiting researcher

Max-Planck Institute for Biological Cybernetics, Tübingen, Germany (Host: Prof. Peter Dayan)

EDUCATION

April 2021 - September 2025

Doctor of Philosophy in Psychology

Department of Cognitive and Psychological Sciences, Graduate school of Informatics, Nagoya University, Aichi, Japan

September 2017 - November 2018

Master of Research in Cognitive Neuroscience

Institute of Cognitive Neuroscience, Division of Psychology and Language Sciences, Faculty of Brain Sciences, University College London, London, United Kingdom

April 2013 - March 2017

Bachelor of Arts in Psychology

Department of Psychology, College of Humanities and Sciences, Nihon University, Tokyo, Japan

DISSERTATION

Doctoral thesis (April 2021 – September 2025)

Title: The role of melatonin in emotion control and inequality aversion

Primary Supervisor: Prof. Hideki Ohira

Master's thesis (September 2017 - November 2018)

Title: How does melatonin contribute to emotion regulation?

First Supervisor: Dr. Pranjal Mehta, *Second Supervisor:* Prof. Jonathan Roiser

Bachelor thesis (April 2015 - March 2017)

Title: Cognitive complexity and fairness perceptions in social interactions

Advisor: Prof. Takashi Oka

RESEARCH INTEREST

Emotion, emotion regulation, mood / anxiety disorder, insomnia / sleep disorder, social decision-making, neuromodulators / hormones

RESEARCH SKILLS

Computer Skills (Word processing, Spreadsheets, Powerpoint), Programming and Statistical Skills (SPSS, R, MATLAB (Cogent Toolbox), PsychoPy, JATOS and jsPsych), fMRI (SPM (Anatomy Toolbox)), ECG and EDA (BIOPAC and AcqKnowledge), Pharmacological manipulation (Double-blind), Saliva testing (Enzyme immunoassay), Computational modelling (R, Rstan), Medical Screening Procedures

SCHOLARSHIPS, FELLOWSHIPS and HONOURS

2026: Postdoctoral Fellowship, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS)

2025: Accepted into the fully funded Research Student Attachment Programme at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

2023: Fellowship, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS) - Overseas Challenge Program for Young Researchers

2021-2023: Tuition Waiver, Nagoya University

2017: Watanabe Research Award, Nihon University

2015-2017: Merit-Based Scholarship, Nihon University

2016: Funding, Japanese Government Institute (JASSO) – Program for Prospective Graduate Students to Study Abroad

PUBLICATION OF JOURNALS

M. Kurihara & H. Ohira (2024). Relationship Between Salivary Melatonin and Interoceptive Awareness. Neuroendocrinology Letters, 45(4).

M. Kurihara & H. Ohira (2024). Endogenous Melatonin and Impulsivity in Humans. Neuroendocrinology Letters, 45(7-8).

M. Kurihara & H. Ohira (2022). Pilot Study: Melatonin Modulates Responses to Emotional Stimuli in the Emotional Stroop Task. PsyArXiv.

M. Kurihara, S. Prasad, S. Liu, P. H. Mehta, H. Critchley & H. Ohira. Melatonin influences emotion regulation in the Ultimatum Game. Manuscript in preparation. (OSF preregistration)

M. Kurihara, N. Saito & H. Ohira. Melatonin increases emotional reactions in social decision-making. Manuscript in preparation.

ORAL PRESENRATION

M. Kurihara (June 2024). The Relationship Between Melatonin and Social Decision-Making. Presented at the Psychoneuroendocrinoimmunology (PNEI) Conference, Sendai, Japan.

POSTER PRESENTATION

M. Kurihara, N. Saito, & H. Ohira (Sep 2024). The Relationship Between Melatonin and Emotion Regulation: The Effect of Melatonin on Emotion Regulation in Terms of Psychophysiological Measurements. Presented at the Japanese Psychological Society, Kumamoto, Japan.

M. Kurihara, N. Saito, & H. Ohira (Sep 2023). Melatonin Modulates Emotion Regulation in Social Decision-Making. Presented at the International Society of Psychoneuroendocrinology, London, UK.

M. Kurihara, N. Saito, & H. Ohira (Apr 2023). Melatonin Modulates Emotional Reactions to Unfair Offers in the Ultimatum Game. Presented at the Social and Affective Neuroscience Society, Santa Barbara, US.

M. Kurihara & H. Ohira (Sep 2022). Melatonin Affects Cognitive Performance to Emotional Stimuli in the Emotional Stroop Task. Presented at the International Society of Psychoneuroendocrinology, Chicago, US.

M. Kurihara, H. Ohira, & P. H. Mehta (Oct 2021). Melatonin Increases the Selection of Rejection to Unfairness in the Ultimatum Game. Virtually presented at the Society for Neuroeconomics.

M. Kurihara, H. Ohira, & P. H. Mehta (Sep 2021). Melatonin Increases the Selection of Rejection to Unfairness in the Ultimatum Game. Virtually presented at the Japanese Psychological Society.

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Kurihara, M., Saito, N., & Ohira, H. (2024). Melatonin Modulates Emotion Regulation in Social Decision-Making. Psychoneuroendocrinology, 160, 106880.

Kurihara, M., & Ohira, H. (2023). Melatonin Affects Cognitive Performance to Emotional Stimuli in the Emotional Stroop Task. Psychoneuroendocrinology, 153, 106180.

RESEARCH & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant: Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (KAKENHI) Project, Senshu University (2027–2028)

Lecturer (Part-Time): Statistical Methods in Psychology, International University of Health and Welfare (2027)

Teaching Assistant: Advanced Psychological Data Analysis, Senshu University (2027-2028)

Teaching Assistant: Undergraduate Seminars, Nagoya University (2022-2023)

Research Assistant: Psychophysiological Experiments, Nagoya University (2021-2023)

Lecturer (Part-Time): Psychological Experiments, Research Methods, and Social Psychology, Tokyo Fukushi University (2022-23)

Research Assistant: RISTEX Project, RIKEN Institute (2019-2020)

RESEARCH GRANT

Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows (KAKENHI) (2027-2029): ¥3,150,000

Nagoya University PhD Research Grant (2023): ¥272,000

Nagoya University PhD Research Grant (2021): ¥380,000

INVITED TALK

The Effect of Melatonin on Emotion Regulation and Inequality Aversion. Invited talk at the University of Tokyo, Japan (2024).

How Does Melatonin Contribute to Emotion Regulation? Invited talk at CiNet Institute, Japan (2019).